

4 Development of dictatorship: Italy, 1918-45

	• Post-war discontent in Italy • Growing support for Fascism, 1919-22 • The founding of the Fascist state under Mussolini • Domestic policies and life in Fascist Italy • The impact of the Second World War on Italy
• Weaknesses of the Italian system of government. Italian discontent with the Versailles Peace Settlement. The growth of socialism. Failure of Italian government's 1919-22. D'Annunzio and Fiume. Economic and social effects of the war, including the wave of strikes, 1919-20. • Mussolini and the formation of the Fascist Party, its aims and organisation. Fascist activities 1919-22. Giolitti and Fascist alliance. The March on Rome. • The Fascist dictatorship – the one-party state, the Acerbo Electoral Law of 1923, the murder of Matteotti, censorship and the police state and the OVRA. • The Lateran Treaty and the Corporate State. Mussolini's economic policies including the Battles of Wheat and Lira, public works and the draining of the Pontine Marshes. The impact of the Great Depression. The Battle for Births and control of the youth including education and youth movements, the Balilla. • Entry in 1940. Effects of war on the home front. Growth of opposition and German occupation. Puppet ruler and circumstances leading to Mussolini's death.	